

Kingdom of the Sun

Kingdom Media Production · The Number

Built 2026-06-01. Internal, for BJ to set the figure he brings to the committee. These are planning estimates, real numbers depend on the trip, sales volume, and sponsorship. BJ sets the final asks.

The strategy in one line

Ask the committee for a modest production fee. Earn the real money from families and sponsors. Most of your income does not come out of the committee's pocket, which is exactly why your ask fits right in next to everyone else getting paid.

1. Break-even first (what being there costs you)

You're flying in from LA over the holidays. Cover this before anything counts as "paid":

Item	Estimate
Round-trip flight (LAX → Orlando, holiday)	~\$550
Hotel, 6 nights @ ~\$150	~\$900
Rental car, ~6 days	~\$400
Food / incidentals	~\$400
Trip cost (break-even)	~\$2,250

Your production fee has to clear this first.

2. The committee ask (the number to bring)

This is the part the committee votes on. Keep it clean and defensible.

	Amount	Framing
Production fee	Open at \$5,000, settle ~\$4,000-4,500	“Covers my travel from Los Angeles plus four days running the complete media production: photography, video, the website, and all content.”
Builder retainer (website, annual)	\$1,500 / yr	“Keeps the official site live and updated year-round.”
Committee-funded total	~\$6,000 / yr	The only part that touches the tournament budget

Why this lands: it’s clearly more than a local day-rate photographer because you fly in and run *everything* (photo + video + site + archive), but it’s a single line the committee can approve without it competing with anyone’s stipend. Open at \$5,000 so there’s room to settle around \$4,000-4,500.

3. Your full take (the real picture, Year 1)

The fee is the floor. Here’s the stack, and most of it never hits the committee budget:

Line	Who pays	Conservative	Growth
Production fee	Committee	\$4,000	\$5,000
Builder retainer	Committee	\$1,500	\$2,500
Photo sales (families/players)	Families	\$1,500	\$3,500
Video / highlight reels (recruiting tape)	Families	\$2,000	\$5,000
Championship recap + prints	Families/fans	\$500	\$1,500
Sponsor media add-ons	Sponsors	\$500	\$2,000
Year 1 total		~\$10,000	~\$19,500

Roughly **\$5,500-7,500 from the committee, the rest (\$4,500-12,000) earned directly** from families and sponsors, money that does not exist today and competes with no one.

The math behind the consumer lines: 16 teams, ~190 players. If even a third of families buy a photo package and you sell 15-25 highlight reels, those two lines alone clear \$3,500-8,500. That’s the upside that grows every year as the field gets bigger, which you’re also building.

4. Why it fits the committee

- Your committee ask (~\$6k) is one modest line, not a budget-buster.
 - The bulk of your income comes from **new money** (family photo/video sales, sponsor media) that the tournament has never captured.
 - You're not taking from anyone's stipend, you're adding a revenue and quality layer that didn't exist.
 - You fly in, run the whole production, and leave behind a website + archive that lifts the event every year. That's worth more than the ask.
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5. The one-line ask to bring

"For the media, I'm asking \$4,500 to cover my travel from LA and run the full production, photo, video, the website, and content, plus a \$1,500 retainer to keep the site live year-round. Everything beyond that I earn directly from photo and video sales to families, so it's not on the tournament's budget."

Notes

- Adjust the \$4,500 up or down to land just at or above what the tournament director makes, given you're doing far more.
- If the committee budget is tight, hold the fee at \$3,500 (still clears the trip + a bit) and lean harder on the consumer lines, your real upside is there anyway.
- Revisit the number each year as the tournament grows.